

DANIEL MONTEIRO CUNHA

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Professional Summary

Project Manager with a background in materials science and experimental research. Experienced in coordinating complex research environments, structuring multi-stakeholder projects, and driving process improvements using Lean methodologies. Bridges scientific insight with operational execution to enable efficient and reproducible research.

Selected Impact

- Reduced recurring laboratory costs by more than €25K per year by bringing outsourced work in-house and redesigning laboratory procedures.
- Coordinated corrective actions for a €2.5M research system that had not met specification, ensuring supplier accountability and aligning users, technical staff, and the manufacturer through the current testing phase.
- Coordinated a laboratory relocation across multiple stakeholders and supported equipment planning and post-move troubleshooting.

Professional Experience

Project Manager

2026–Present

University of Twente

Enschede, NL

- Lead research operations and coordinate planning, milestones, resources, and workflows across MSc, PhD, and postdoctoral projects.
- Currently developing a scalable group onboarding framework and piloting an interactive AFM training solution that could later be adapted for other instruments.

Senior Scientist

2021–2026

University of Twente

Enschede, NL

- Led research infrastructure and experimental design; supervised students and supported advanced material characterization.

Researcher & PhD Researcher

2015–2021

University of Twente

Enschede, NL

- Conducted research on oxide thin films and nanoscale materials; developed experimental methods and simulations; supervised students.

Education

PhD in Materials Science

University of Twente

Enschede, NL

Skills

- **Project Management:** Research operations, multi-project coordination, stakeholder management, resource planning, milestone tracking
- **Process Improvement:** Lean Green Belt (completed May 2026), Kaizen, workflow optimization
- **Technical:** Experimental design, Design of Experiments, PLD, SPM, Python, data analysis, research software

Languages

Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (intermediate), Dutch (basic)

Personal Interests

Running, Boulderling, Drumming, Cooking, Reading